



GULSHAN | NORTH KARACHI | ORANGI

ENGLISH – XI

According to New Course - 2022

An Effort of: Engr. Nasim Zulfiqar

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Poem#01

"THE CHARACTER OF A HAPPY LIFE"

Introduction of the Poet

The poem "The Character of a Happy Life", has been written by Sir Henry Wotton. He was born in Kent and the son of country gentleman. In this poem Wotton has described the characteristics of a person who can truly be called a happy man.

Introduction of the Poem

We find Wotton's poem is a sharp sense of contrast between the uneasy life of the ambitious man and the contented life of man satisfied to live an obscure life of peaceful virtue. Sir Henry Wotton wrote from experience; for he was a distinguished servant of the crown who had seen for himself the rise and fall of ambitious men. The poem consisting of six stanzas of regular couplet rhymed.

"Nature is the peace not the Land."

John Keats

Summary

A person who has freedom of will and thought leads a happy life. He does not act according to other people's wishes. His only weapon is his simplicity and truth.

Such an upright man is not a slave of his desires. He is always prepared for death. This man is not concerned about being famous or in what people say about him publicly or privately.

This upright man is not jealous of chance or foul play. He knows that flattery gives the deepest wounds. He does not abide by the rules of the society which compel a person to do unwanted deeds. He follows the rules of goodness which will lead him to the right path.

A happy man's life is freed from numerous when he is sad, he retires in his comfort of clear conscience. He hasn't got a high position. Therefore, people don't flatter him or nick him at his down fall. A happy man prays to God regularly. In this prayer he does not ask for rocks but he asks God to be gracious and merciful on him. His favorite positive is good book or friend. A man who is truly happy is free from slavery of his desires. He isn't ambitious. He does not expect too much therefore his hopes aren't shattered. He doesn't fear a downfall. This man hasn't got lands or wealth and yet he has everything. He has got the greatest wealth of contentment and happiness.

"Multiple Choice Questions"

1. The poem "Character of a happy life" is composed by _____.

William Shakespeare	Sir Henry Wotton	Thomas Campion	Sir Walter Scott
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2. Sir Henry Wotton was born in _____.

1639	1568	1564	1546
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3. Sir Henry Wotton was a _____ poet.

Romantic	Religious	Imaginative	Supernatural
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4. Sir Henry Wotton was born in _____.

Cocker mouth	Kent	Sussex	Dublin
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5. _____ King gave him a regular pension.

James	John	Tom	Edward
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6. How happy is he born or _____.

Teach	Taught	Learnt	Behaved
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7.	And simple truth his utmost _____.	Art	Variety	Habit	Skill
8.	Whose passions not his _____ are.	Governor	Master	Companion	Comrade
9.	Of public fame, or _____ breath;	Private	Mass	Friend	None of them
10.	Who _____ none that chance doth raise.	Envies	Jealous	Pride	Vanity
11.	How deepest wounds are given by _____.	Admiration	Praise	Money	Good
12.	Whose _____ is his strong retreat?	Conscience	Body	Mind	None of them
13.	The man is freed from _____ band.	Servile	Natural	Acts	Habits
14.	Of hope to rise, or fear to _____.	Fall	Down	Up	Earth
15.	With a _____ book or friend.	Religious	Romantic	Natural	Dramatic
16.	The strong retreat of a man is his _____.	heart	Thoughts	Mind	conscience
17.	According to the poet, a happy man cares much about _____.	Worldly needs	Material uplift	Character	finance
18.	A happy man's armour is his _____ thought.	Clever	Honesty	Deep	Lofty
19.	A happy man's days are _____.	joyful	Carefree	Harmless	playful
20.	_____ is the utmost skill of an honest man.	Truth	Honesty	Simplicity	Wisdom
21.	A happy man does not serve another's _____.	Order	Direction	Wish	Will
22.	A happy man's soul is always prepared for _____.	Exam	Fight	Quarrel	Death
23.	According to the poet, the deepest wounds are always given by _____.	Back biting	Praise	Trust	Friendship

“QUESTIONS & ANSWERS”

Q#1 What sort of freedom does he enjoy according to the lines “United unto the world” by care of public fame or private breath?

Ans: A happy man discerns that the world is full of color. He does not involve himself in the worldly gains and beauty. He does not want to be famous among the people and does not want to be famous among the people and does take care about the intentions & opinion of the people which they will establish about him.

Q#2 Briefly explain the meaning of the word “Nor rules of state” & “Rules of good”.

Ans: Basically, the poets distinguish between the types of governing. Firstly “Rules of state” means to the country or the state. Each and every government follows certain rules but this rule fulfills her interest and intentions and sometimes proves insolvent for the country men. While “Rules of good” means he has got triumph over the hearts and the emotions of the people. He uses the mild accent and preaches good teaching of God among them which make them aware about the weight of life.

Q#3 Why did he get deepest wounds by praise?

Ans: A pious man hates flattery because it spoils anybody's nature. It may also bring enmity. That's why he got deepest wounds by Praise.

"Envy is a great sin and spoils anybody's nature" (Oscar Wilde)

Q#4 What is meant by "Whose passions not his master are and whose soul is still prepared for death"?

Ans: The poet is describing the foremost qualities of the modest man. He asserts that a pious man has total command over his desire. He never runs behind the worldly gains. The second quality of a pious person is that he is fully prepared to meet the Almighty Allah because he spends his life according to the dogmas which is prescribed by God.

Q#5: Attempt to explain briefly how Sir Henry Wotton's Happy Man 'having nothing yet hath all.'

Ans: A happy man does not have very much with respect to material objects. He may not have vast and wide lands or bank balance or other luxuries, but he possesses contented mind and a happy and joyful heart. This is what Henry Wotton called "everything" in this poem. Because,

"A contented mind is the greatest blessing a man can enjoy in this world."

Q#6: Why does a happy man pray to God?

Ans: A happy man always prays to God, not because of His material blessings or worldly objects but because He is almighty, He is worth-adoration, and He deserves to be prayed and worshiped.

Q#7 Describe the lines "Whose passions not his masters are"

Ans: In their lines the poet describes one of the foremost qualities of a man who bears such a good character. He has total command over his passions. He does not allow his character to destroy under the influence of his passion & sentiments.

Q#8 Describe the lines of "Public Fame, or Private Breath"?

Ans: A pious man has complete awareness about the way of the world. He does not involve himself a lot in this world to become famous and does not care what gossips tell about him in private furthermore he enjoys his life in care free manner.

Q#9 Who is free from servile band and how?

Ans: The man who does not indulge himself in the materialistic world is free from servile band because he has no hope to rise and fear to fall but has hope for the rewards in the second world.

Q10: How does Sir Henry Wotton's man enjoy his spare-time? (Important)

Ans: Sir Henry Wotton's man enjoys his spare time in praying to God and reading the religious books. He spends his days in harmless joys. He never perplexes others and he is even jealous of no one. His whole day is the model of an idealistic life.

Q11: What does Henry Wotton's man use for his defense? (Important)

Ans: Henry Wotton's man had a character that helps him to live a happy life in the world and in here after as well. Henry Wotton's man is a paragon of upright man. He is honest enough morally and practically so he was not envied by any person and thus has no enemy as well. Relying on this fact, Wotton's man neither needs towers nor armor for his defense. He is well defended by his honest thoughts and deeds. His life is a paradigm of happy living.

Q12: What are the qualities of a happy man as described in the poem, 'The Character of a Happy Life.'? (Important)

Ans: A happy man has following good qualities:

- i) He is not a slave to other people's wishes, and is master of his own will.
- ii) He has full control over his passions and desires.
- iii) He does not envy anybody who has risen to a high position either by chance or through some wicked means.
- iv) He prays to God Day and night. He thanks God more for His grace rather than for worldly gifts that He has given him.
- v) He passes his day in reading a good book or in the company of a good friend.

Q13: What does the poet mean when he says that a happy man does not serve another's will? OR What a happy man is taught from his very birth? (Important)

Ans: According to Sir Henry Wotton, a happy man does not serve's another will. He is the master of himself. He does what his heart says. He is not a puppet on the hands of others. Whatever decisions a happy man takes in his life is based upon his own will and not of others.

Q14: What is the central idea of the poem, 'The Character of Happy Life'? (Important)

Ans: The poet described the characteristics of a noble and happy man, who is honest, simple, not slave of his desires. He follows the rules of goodness, which will lead him to the right path.

Q15: Write the rhyming scheme of the poem. (Important)

Ans: The rhyming scheme of this poem is ABAB. First line rhymes with the third line while second line rhymes with the fourth line.'



Poem#2

Don't Quit

Introduction to the Poet

Edgar Albert Guest (1881-1959) was born in Birmingham, England but was educated in United States as his family moved there. Owing to his themes and languages used in his works, he became known as the People's poet. His poems often had an inspirational and optimistic view of everyday life. His poetry was read the most during the first half of the 20th century. His first book, "A Heap O' Livin' became a best-seller. It was followed by similar collections of his optimistic rhymes, Just Folks (1918), Rhythms of Childhood (1924), Life's Highway (1933), and Living the Years (1949)

Central Idea of the Poem

Don't Quit is a motivational poem which motivates us to never quit for any cause. It's all about **perseverance, tenacity, determination and will-power to not to give up** - especially when the things are going wrong, and when one is seemingly swimming against the tide. This poem reminds us that there are seeds of success in every failure, and that's why we mustn't quit.

Words-Meanings

Words	Meanings
Trudge	To walk slowly
Quit	To Stop
Queer	Stage
Pace	Speed
Twist	An unexpected change
Stuck	Caught
Tint	Shade
Sigh	A long deep breath

“Multiple Choice Questions”

- The figure of speech in “The silver tint of the cloud of doubt is _____”

A	Personification	B	Metaphor	C	Onomatopoeia	D	Simile
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- When the things seem worst', we should _____.

A	Run away	B	Take some other way	C	Stop moving ahead	D	Stick to them
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- “You might succeed with another blow”, means you _____.

A	Give the blow	B	Receive the blow	C	Continue the struggle	D	Withdraw the struggle
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- The struggler learns too late that he _____.

A	Was unable to struggle	B	Was close to his victory	C	Should have taken rest	D	Should have quit
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- The moral of the poem is that we should _____.

A	Face challenges of life	B	Enjoy success	C	Run away from the hardships of life	D	Only think positively
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- 'So stick to the fight when you're _____.'

A	Hardest hit	B	Betrayed	C	Unhappy	D	Unlucky
---	-------------	---	----------	---	---------	---	---------

7. The phrase 'golden crown' means _____.

A	Wealth	B	Power	C	Victory	D	Throne
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8. In the first stanza of the poem, 'sigh' symbolizes _____.

A	Happiness	B	Regret	C	Courage	D	Pain
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“QUESTIONS & ANSWERS”

Q1: What is the poet's message in the first stanza? (Important)

Ans: Life is a journey and it is not always easy. Sometimes it is pleasant while other times things tend to go wrong. Regardless of how meticulously you have planned everything, some things still go awry. There are times when the funds are limited and one finds themselves in debt they must persist. Stop for a while and take a rest but do not give up. When a person gives up, life becomes meaningless. There is nothing worthwhile to fight for and all will to live diminishes. Although the problem seems colossal, if they only fight for a little longer, victory will be theirs. The progress may seem slow but you are still progressing and that is a sign of success. One more try and you shall succeed.

Q2: Why does the poet term life 'queer with twists and turns?' (Important)

Ans: The poet means by this phrase that time never remains same for everyone. No one knows what is there in the future ahead. Life is full of suspense. It has twists and turns. Trough and crest are a part of life. The good times and bad times are equally unpredictable.

Q3: What is the benefit of not quitting as suggested in the poem? (Important)

Ans: Humans have a tendency to work within their comfort zone and when a hardship strikes, they tend to flee or battle with it only for a while before giving up. However, this poem significantly inspires all its readers to never quit and never give up in the face of calamity. This is life and it is full of surprises. Think of it as a ride, sometimes high and sometimes low. The one who manages to stick until the end wins the victory cup. Although the victory seems far, it is close. One must just persevere.

Poem#3

Ozymandias

Introduction of the Poet

Percy Bysshe Shelley (1792-1822) was born in Sussex and educated at Eton and University College, Oxford. He was a close friend of Byron and a generous admirer of Keats, whose death moved him to write the great elegy, Adonais. His notable works include Prometheus Unbound, the Cenci, Lines Written Among the Euganean Hills, Ode to the West Wind, The Cloud and many others. His greatest passages have a pure and intense lyrical quality that demands his recognition as a major poet. Like so many English poets, he loved the sea, a love which cost his life for he was drowned when sailing a small boat of Spezia.

Central Idea of the Poem

Ozymandias was a Greek name for the Egyptian pharaoh Ramesses II, famous for the number of architectural structures which he got constructed. Shelley wrote the poem Ozymandias which describes a broken state of Ramesses II, lying forgotten in the desert. The theme of the poem is that Graveyards are full of the people who thought themselves indispensable.

Words-Meanings

Words	Meanings
Frown	A displeasing or concentrating face
Visage	A human or animal face
Sculptor	An artist who makes sculpture
Mock	Make fun of
Pedestal	The base of sculpture
Colossal	Huge
Remains	The parts left over

“Multiple Choice Questions”

1. 'Ozymandias' is a poem depicting that life is _____.

A Beautiful	B Transient	C Attractive	D Alluring
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2. The poet met a traveller from:

A An ancient land	B Abroad	C A neighboring Country	D A desert
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3. The traveller told the poet that he had seen _____ in the desert.

A A statue	B A sculptor	C An oasis	D A snake
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4. The words on the base of statue tell us that the king Ozymandias was a _____ king.

A Kind	B Humble	C Proud	D Cruel
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5. The message of the poem for all powerful authority and glory is _____.

A 'Sand stretch far away'	B 'Frown and wrinkled lips'	C 'Nothing remains'	D 'Stamped on these lifeless things'
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6. In the poem, 'Ozymandias', the condition of the statue is _____.

A Good	B Bad	C Excellent	D Marvellous
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7. 'My name is Ozymandias – King of Kings;' is _____ literary device.

A	Simile	B	Irony	C	Personification	D	Metaphor
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8. One of the following lines does NOT make use of alliteration in the poem.

A	The lone and level sands stretch far away.	B	I met a traveller from an antique land	C	Nothing beside remains. Round the decay.	D	Half sunk, a shattered visage lies, whose frown
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“QUESTIONS & ANSWERS”

Q1: What did the traveller see in the desert and whom he told about it? (Important)

Ans: The traveller saw a trunkless statue of Ozymandias in the desert. The visage of statue lay near the statue half sunk. He told the poet, Percy Bysshe Shelley, about this statue.

Q2: How can you say that the sculptor was a great artist? (Important)

Ans: The sculptor who made the statue of Ozymandias was indeed a great artist as he had observed Ozymandias very carefully before making the sculpture. The cruelty and proud nature of Ozymandias was clearly shown on the shattered visage. Ozymandias died long ago but once you see the sculpture of him, you will get to know about all his characteristics.

Q3: What was written on the pedestal of the statue of Ozymandias? (Important)

Ans: On the pedestal of the statue of Ozymandias the following lines are written:

“My name is Ozymandias, King of Kings;

Look on my Works, ye Mighty, and despair!”

Q4: What is the meaning of the phrase in the poem, “the heart that fed”? (Important)

Ans: The phrase “the heart that fed” clearly reflects that the sculptor had made the statue whole heartedly. He thoroughly observed the physical attributes of Ozymandias and then ventured to make the statue of him.

Q5: What is ironic about the fate of Ozymandias? (Important)

Ans: It seems ironical that the proud words written on the pedestal of statue mocks at the situation present around it. There was a barren desert all around the statue and there were no buildings or greenery.

Q6: What is the message of the poem? (Important)

Ans: Ozymandias was a Greek name for the Egyptian pharaoh Ramesses II, famous for the number of architectural structures which he got constructed. Shelley wrote the poem Ozymandias which describes a broken state of Ramesses II, lying forgotten in the desert. The theme of the poem is that Graveyards are full of the people who thought themselves indispensable.

Q7: The proud Ozymandias lies forgotten in the desert. Comment. (Important)

Ans: Ozymandias was a proud and cruel Egyptian King. He thought that his empire and his name would live forever but he was mistaken in this sense. He ordered he sculptor to make his colossal statue below which some proud lines were written. After a long time, his dynasty vanished and Egypt became a desert. His statue was also shattered due to some reasons. Now, his statue is trunkless without a visage. Nothing remarkable exists beside his statue except the sand dunes.

Poem#4

Good Timber

Introduction of the Poet

Douglas Malloch was an American poet. He is also known as lumberman's poet because of writing so much for woodcutters and simple forest life.

Central Idea of the Poem

"A man grows when he comes out of his comfort zone."

Words	Meanings
Timber	Wood used to make furniture
Scrubby	Unimportant
Toil	Hardship
Patriarchs	Guardian
Counsel	Talk
Scars	Marks of wound

"Multiple Choice Questions"

1. The poem explain to us that good qualities always develop in _____.

a	Hardships	b	Ease	c	Idleness	d	Illness
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2. "Never became a forest king" means never _____.

A	Became a lion	b	Acquired a prominent position	c	Possessed courage to fight	d	Enjoyed life
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3. "But lived and died as he began" points out towards _____ human being.

A	A courageous	b	An effortless	c	A wealthy	d	A successful
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4. In the poem, "Good Timber", the poet discusses themes of _____.

A	Nature, wealth & defeat	b	Power, relationship & hope	c	Nature, struggle & fulfilment	d	Nature, nurture & chaos
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5. The poem teaches us that the people reach their true potential by overcoming _____.

a	Feelings	b	Enemies	c	Desires	d	Adversities
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6. "But lived and died a scrubby thing" means lived a/an _____ life.

a	Unimportant	b	High status	c	Useful	d	Comfortable
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7. "By Sun and sold, by rain and snow" is _____ literary device.

a	Metaphor	b	Oxymoron	c	Alliteration	d	Simile
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8. "Broken branches" in last stanza is the example of _____.

a	Simile	b	Metaphor	c	Hyperbole	d	None of these
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“QUESTIONS & ANSWERS”

Q1: What is the significance of the title of the poem? (Important)

Ans: “Good Timber” means the wood of fine quality which is used for making furniture. It is a metaphorical statement which has been used for human beings. The good qualities grow in a human being after facing adversities.

Q2: What happens to the people who work hard? (Important)

Ans: The people who work hard create a difference in this world. Success kisses the feet of those persons who strive hard in their life.

Q3: How can one achieve one’s true potential in life according to the poem? (Important)

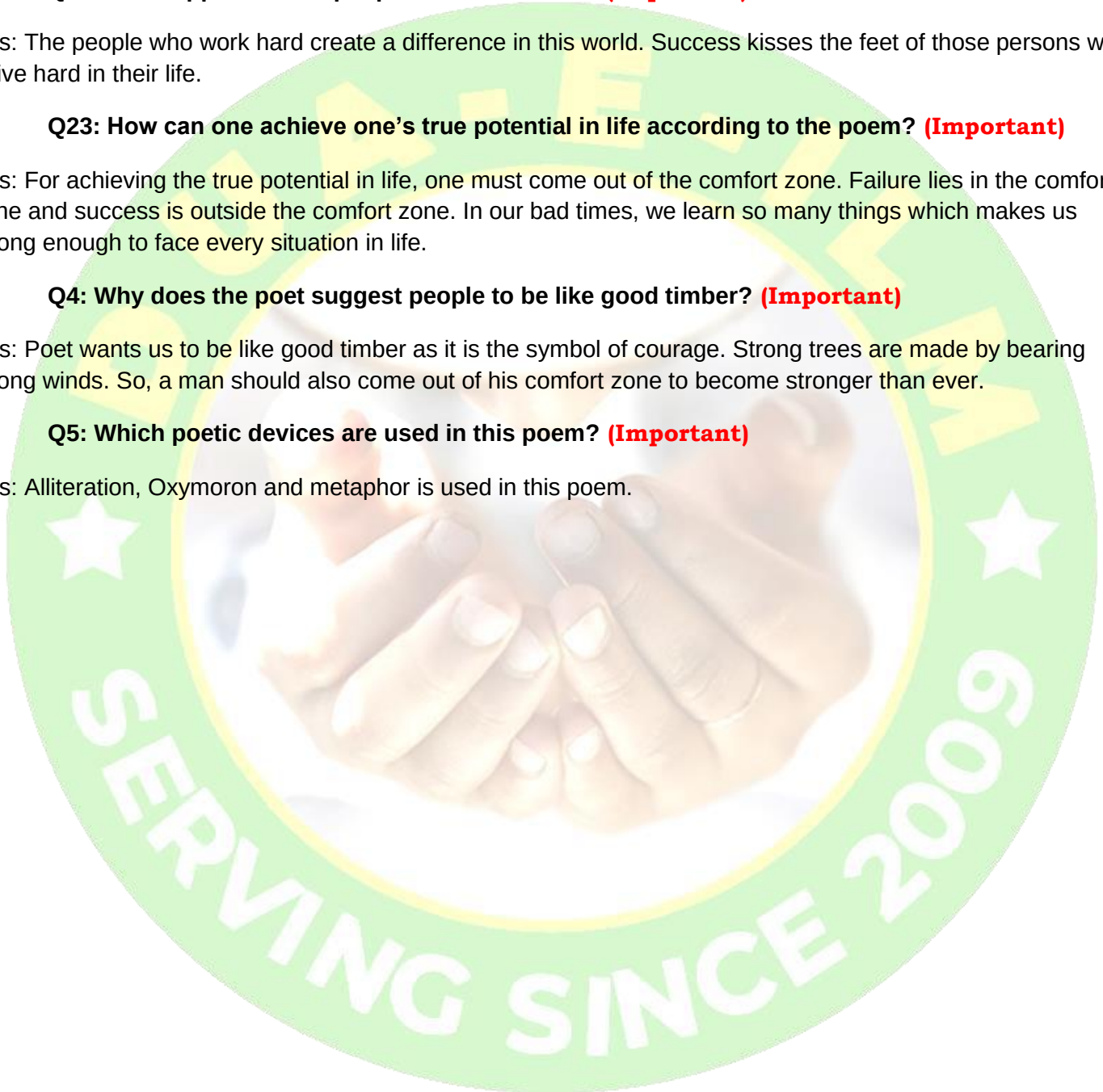
Ans: For achieving the true potential in life, one must come out of the comfort zone. Failure lies in the comfort zone and success is outside the comfort zone. In our bad times, we learn so many things which makes us strong enough to face every situation in life.

Q4: Why does the poet suggest people to be like good timber? (Important)

Ans: Poet wants us to be like good timber as it is the symbol of courage. Strong trees are made by bearing strong winds. So, a man should also come out of his comfort zone to become stronger than ever.

Q5: Which poetic devices are used in this poem? (Important)

Ans: Alliteration, Oxymoron and metaphor is used in this poem.



Poem#5

LUCY GRAY

Introduction of the Poet

William Word Worth was born in 1770 at Cocker mouth in Lake District. He was educated at Hawk shed Grammar School and then at St. John's College, Cambridge. His early poems reflect his love for natural beauty, which he expressed in a unique and artificial style. Some of William's poems are Lyrical Ballads, Poems in Two Volumes and An Evening Walk. William Words Worth is also known for his achievements as a critic.

Introduction of the Poem

Poem entitled Lucy Gray was written in 1799 and published in the second edition of "Lyrical Ballads." It tells us the story of a simple tragedy in a cold bleak countryside. The poem has a steady and regular rhythm as a longer lines rhyme together as well as the shorter lines rhyme with each other. The language of the ballad is plain and simple.

Summary

Lucy Gray was a beautiful little girl who lived in a wild moor with her parents. Their house was located in the countryside far away from the cities. Nobody neighbored their house and Lucy lived without having any friends and playmates.

In Western countryside, it is said that if the moon is clearly seen during daylight, a storm appears in that area. One-day Lucy's mother went town for shopping in the noon. After a while, he father realized that the moon can be seen and predicted a storm in few hours. He quickly told Lucy to take a lantern and go to the town to help her mother. Lucy obeyed her father and was on her way to the city.

Unfortunately, the storm appeared as soon as Lucy left for the town. It started to snow thickly that made it difficult for Lucy to see through. As she was wandering in the snowy atmosphere, she fell in a crevice and died. Her mother somehow returned home at night.

When the little girl did not come back, her parents went out in the snowy mountains shouting for their daughter, but they never found Lucy. On their way home, they found footprints on a wooden bridge in the middle. They concluded that perhaps Lucy Gray fell down and had died.

When we go through the hills, a solitary song is heard in the wind, which echoes in the mountains. Some people think that she died that day while some say she lives as a part of nature.

"Multiple Choice Questions"

1. Lucy Gray was composed by _____.

William Shakespeare	Shelly	William Wordsworth	Spenser
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2. "Lucy Gray" was written in _____.

1799	1800	1770	1802
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3. Lucy Gray was published in _____.

1799	1800	1770	1802
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4. William words worth was born in _____.

1770	1850	1770	1746
------	------	------	------

5. William Wordsworth was born at _____.

Cocker mouth	Dublin	Sussex	Kent
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6. Lucy Gray was appeared in the 2nd edition of _____ ballads.

Ironical	Critical	Lyrical	Social
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7. "Lucy Gray was the model of _____.

	Obedience	Faithfulness	Sincerity	Locality
8.	Lucy Gray lives in the wide_____.			
	Village	City	Moor	Hovel
9.	Lucy Gray became the victim of_____.			
	Earthquake	Storm	Flood	None of them
10.	Lucy Gray took the_____to guide her.			
	Bulb	Stick	Lantern	Father
11.	No mate, no_____Lucy knew.			
	Friend	Comrade	Companion	Cousin
12.	You yet may spy the_____at play.			
	Have	Deer	Fawn	Sparrow
13.	To-night will be a_____night.			
	Misty	Stormy	Dark	Gloomy
14.	The minster-clock has just struck_____.			
	2	3	5	6
15.	Not blither is the mountain_____.			
	Hare	Antelope	Roe	Deer
16.	The_____came on before it is time.			
	Storm	Flood	Earthquake	None of them
17.	The_____parents all that night.			
	Fortunate	Unfortunate	Wretched	Miserable
18.	Yet some_____that to this day.			
	Observe	Percept	Maintain	Keep
19.	And sings a_____song.			
	Melancholy	Melodious	Classical	Proc
20.	That_____in the wind.			
	Whistle	Flow	Glideth	Stop
21.	William Wordsworth was died in_____.			
	1872	1850	1851	1852
22.	The poet chanced to see Lucy Gray_____.			
	At the break of day	In the evening	In the afternoon	At night
23.	Lucy's father asked Lucy to go to the town with a lantern to bring her_____.			
	Aunt	Sister	Brother	mother
24.	Lucy replied to her father that she would_____go to the town to take back her mother.			
	Gladly	Sadly	Unwillingly	probably
25.	Lucy couldn't reach the town because_____.			
	It was late	She didn't get any conveyance	Her mother reached home	She lost her way in storm
26.	The wooden bridge was at distance of_____from Lucy's home.			
	A mile	A furlong	A kilometer	A few feet
27.	Lucy's parents became certain of her death when they saw_____.			
	Her foot prints	Her body	Her lantern	Her shoes
28.	Some people still believe that Lucy can be seen_____.			
	In mountains	In wind	In town	On bridge
29.	People believe Lucy can be seen doing these activities except_____.			
	Looking straight	Singing songs	Moving rapidly	Talking to people

“QUESTIONS & ANSWERS”

Q#1 Why did William Wordsworth say that Lucy Gray” a solitary child?

Ans. William Wordsworth said “Lucy Gray” a solitary child because she lived on the wild moor. She had no friends and companions to play with. She used to live along with her parents in the unpopulated area.

Q#2 At what time of the day did William Wordsworth see this view?

Ans. William Wordsworth saw this view at the dawn.

Q#3 Why did William Wordsworth remain ignorant to see the sweet face of “Lucy Gray”?

Ans. William Wordsworth remained ignorant to see the sweet face of Lucy Gray because she has become the victim of the storm by drowning into the ditch from the vacant part of the Wooden Bridge.

Q#5 What did Lucy’s parent do after they saw the foot mark of Lucy in the snow?

Ans. When the Lucy’s Parent found the foot mark of Lucy’s feet. They started following them. They tracked the foot marks through the snow then hedge & by the long stone wall and they crossed an open field and reached the middle of the plank of the bridge but they lost her foot marks beyond the middle of bridge.

Q#6 What do people think about Lucy Gray? (Important)

Ans. People think about Lucy Gray that she is alive yet and you can see Wild moor. She sings solitary songs which whistles in the wind but never looks back, this song can be heard by the distance.

Q#7 Briefly narrate the tragic story of Lucy Gray. (Important)

Ans: Lucy was a little girl. She lived alone with her parents, on wide moor. Once when her mother had gone to the market her father saw a full moon in the afternoon which is the prediction of a storm, according to the local belief. Her father asked her to go, with a lantern, to take her mother back. She went on hurriedly. When she was on the way storm came earlier than it was expected. Lucy lost her way and never reached the town. Her parents searched her whole night long, but they could never found her. Some people still believe that she is alive and walks over the moor.

Q#8 Briefly discuss in what ways Lucy Gray resemble the older traditional type of ballad?

Ans: Lucy Gray is an excellent illustration of typical ballads of Northern England. It has a heart-touching story. Its language and narration are simple. An emotional wave continuously flows within the verses. In the last it has a tragic end which is an essential element of northern ballads. So, it is a classical typical northern ballad telling a tragic story.

Q#9 On what observations did the father predict the storm?

Ans: The father, when he was working in his field, saw a full moon in the sky, & it was 2 o’clock in the afternoon so he, according to the local belief, predicted the storm.

Q#10 Where and with whom did Lucy live?

Ans: Lucy lived with her parents in wide green mountainous valley. She was the only child of her parents; she had no neighborhood. Even though, she has no friend and no companion to play with.

Q#11 Why and where had she been going when the storm came?

Ans: Her father asked her to go to take her mother back home from the nearby town. So, she had been going there when the storm came.

Q#12 What do the people say about her, even today?

Ans: People of that area still believe that she has not died. But she is a living child, even today.

Q#13 Who was Lucy Gray and how did she look like?

Ans: Lucy Gray was mere child of her child, a model of obedience, loyalty and faithfulness she was caught in the storm and died. Lucy Gray looked like a fawn at play and hare spying in the green field with joy.

Q#14 Did Lucy Gray prove her an obedient child?

Ans: Once upon a time, Lucy mother went to the town as it was the stormy night that’s why her father commanded her to take a lantern and brought your mother back to the cottage. He accepted

the ordered but unfortunately the storm came before the expected time and gulped her. By showing this conduct, she proved her an obedient child.

Q#15 Why could Lucy gray not reach the town?

Ans: Lucy Gray, the model of obedience, could not reach the town because the storm came before its expected time. She wandered up and down on the hills and at last she lost her way and drowned into the ditch that's why she could not reach the town.

Q#16 How did the parents come to know about the death of Lucy gray? (Important)

Ans: In the beginning, they thought that they lost Lucy Gray. Suddenly, her mother found the food marks of Lucy in the snow; they followed them through the broken hawthorn edge and by the long stone wall, and crossed an open field and saw the same foot marks. In the last, they reached the Wooden bridge which was broken in the middle. They made up their mind, that she was drowned by this space. By this way, she came to know about Lucy death.

Q#17 What did Lucy mean when she said 'yonder is the moon'? (Important)

Ans: Yonder is an archaic word which means 'far away'. When Lucy's father commanded her to go to the town then she said this line. This line means that evening is far away and she would return home from the town before evening.

Q18 Why did Lucy take lantern with her? (Important)

Ans: Lucy took a lantern with her because there was a prediction of upcoming storm. In story weather there is darkness everywhere and the moorland was full of ditches. So, she took a lantern so she would come home with her mother safely.

Q19 Do you think that the tragedy would have been prevented if Lucy's father himself had gone down the town? (Important)

Ans: Yes, the tragedy would have been prevented if Lucy's father himself had gone down the town but he was busy in his work so he persuaded Lucy Gray to go to the town.



Poem#06

"THE ABBOT OF CANTERBURY"

Introduction

The poem The Abbot of Canterbury, included in our book, is a ballad. Ballads have crude language because fine writing would not be suitable for the telling of this straightforward and amusing folk story. King John ruled England from 1199 to 1219, was a very unpleasant man and a thoroughly bad kind.

Structure of Poem

The Abbot of Canterbury is a ballad of unknown poet telling an ancient story consisting of 100 lines of regular rhythm.

Summary

There was a king of England whose name was King John. He ruled England very cruelly and he always did the wrong thing. Once he came to know that there was an Abbot of Canterbury who was leading life better than the king. He had one hundred servants and each one there wore fifty gold chains and velvet coat. They were always ready to serve the Abbot. For very minor things they used to go to the city of London.

This way of leading life angered the king and he sent for the Abbot to explain his position before the king. The Abbot said to him that he was spending the money so luxuriously because he had inherited a lot of money from his fore fathers. The king disbelieved him and charged him to be a traitor.

The king said to Abbot that his life and properties would be confiscated by the government if he could not answer his three questions. There was given three weeks' time to answer those questions.

- The first question was what his worth and value was when he was having such a precious crown on his head.
- The second question was how soon he could make the journey of the whole world.
- The third question was that he was thinking at that time when he was talking to the Abbot of Canterbury.

After listening three questions the Abbot was very much confuse. He confessed that he had no mind to answer those difficult questions. He went to many universities but no one was able to answer him. Then the shepherd of the Abbot offered him that he would imposter the Abbot prodded he was given the relevant dress of the Abbot.

In reply to the first question, he said that his value was twenty-nine pence. In response to the second question, he said if he rose with the sun and rode with the same, he would complete the journey of the world in 24 hours. In response to the third question, he said that he thinking that he was talking to the Abbot by him was not the Abbot but the shepherd. The king was very happy, he rewarded him and pardoned the Abbot.

"Multiple Choice Questions"

1. _____ composed the poem of The Abbot of Canterbury.

Robert Frost	P.B Shelly	William Shakespeare	Anonymous
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2. _____ was the king of England at the time of story.

John	Tom	James	None of them
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3. The poem "The Abbot of Canterbury" belongs to the _____.

	Abbot	King John	Bishop	Pardoner
4.	Abbot was _____ by nature.			
	Hospitable	Wise	Romantic	Courteous
5.	_____ Men were entertained by Abbot in his house.			
	100	50	20	30
6.	The King John felt _____ against Abbot.			
	Courtesy	Jealousy	Hospitable	None of them
7.	_____ reported to King John about the luxurious life style of Abbot.			
	Common People	King's Official	Queen	Shepherd
8.	The King asked _____ questions to Abbot.			
	2	3	1	5
9.	The King gave the space of _____ weeks to answer the riddles.			
	2	3	1	4
10.	Abbot went to Cambridge and _____ University.			
	Oxford	Harvard	Essex	Dublin
11.	Shepherd was going to _____.			
	Home	Church	Fold	Market
12.	_____ gave the answers of three questions.			
	Shepherd	Abbot	Doctor	
13.	There were _____ days left when abbot met the shepherd.			
	3	2	5	7
14.	_____ Days had passed when Abbot met the shepherd.			
	3	18	15	14
15.	First question asked by king is about _____.			
	Worth	Ride the whole	What he thinks	
16.	Second question asked by king is about _____.			
	Worth	Ride the whole	What he thinks	
17.	Third question asked by king is about _____.			
	Worth	Ride the whole	What he thinks	
18.	_____ is the worth of king according to shepherd.			
	30	29	31	28
19.	In _____ hours king will ride the whole world.			
	24	22	21	20
20.	Jesus Christ was sold among the false Jews in _____ pence.			
	20	30	24	29
21.	The shepherd went to the court to _____ him.			
	Pardon	Forgive	Fight	Quarrel
22.	On third answer, king John swear the _____.			
	Mass	Saint John	Saint Bittle	God
23.	The king offered shepherd to be the _____.			
	King	Abbot	Shepherd	Tom
24.	Shepherd can neither write nor _____.			
	Memorize	Read	Learn	Study
25.	The ballad 'The Abbot of Canterbury' is narrated in _____ person.			
	First	Second	Third	First and third
26.	The poet says to the reader that he is going to tell a _____ story.			
	Sad	Funny	Terrible	Folk
27.	King John was jealous of Abbot's housekeeping and high _____.			
	Character	Respect	Business	Renown

28. King John feared that the Abbot was working against his _____.

People	Policies	Crown	Ministers
--------	----------	-------	-----------

29. King John told the Abbot if he did not answer his three questions he would be _____.

Beheaded	Poisoned	Banished	Fined
----------	----------	----------	-------

30. After listening to the King's question, the Abbot rode to _____ universities.

Oxford and California	Oxford & Canterbury	Oxford & Campbell	Oxford & Cambridge
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31. The Abbot requested the King to give him _____ weeks space.

Three	Four	Five	Six
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32. While going back to his home, the Abbot met a _____.

Farmer	Friend	Neighbor	Shepherd
--------	--------	----------	----------

33. The shepherd demanded Abbot's _____ to answer King's questions.

Lands	House	Horse and dress	Wealth
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"QUESTIONS & ANSWERS"

Q#1 What did King John hear about the Abbot?

Ans. The officials of the King John who rode to fair London town told that Abbot was leading a pompous and respectable life which was far better than your way of survival. He had a fully furnished house and he fed/entertained hundred men in single day. He had servant in score who wore fifty gold chain and waited the Abbot return in velvets garments.

Q#2 Why did King John turned against him and what did he decide after hearing about Abbot?

Ans. Because of his envious nature, King John turned against him. He called Abbot and blamed on him that you are working against my crown and for that fault you must lost your life and living. Your safety lies only in the condition if you answer my three questions.

Q#3 What did the Abbot say to the King after having the questions and how many space did he take for answering?

Ans. The Abbot asserted that these questions are very difficult questions for a person like me who got a shallow wit. He took three weeks space to King to answer these questions according to the splendor of the king dignity.

Q#4 What are the three questions and what was the funniest answer of these questions given by the shepherd? (Important)

Ans. The questions which were asked by the King as follow:

1. What was his (King) exact worth when he was sitting on the thrown and crown of gold so fair on his head?
2. How soon he may ride the whole world about?
3. What is the king thinking at that time?

The funniest answer which was applied by shepherd as follow.

1. The Jews Christ was sold among the false Jews in thirty pence so your worth is 29 pence one pence worse than He (J.C)
2. If you ride with the sun and ride with the same so you will consume 24 hours to ride the whole world about.
3. The third answer shepherd gave that you are thinking I am the Abbot but I am a poor shepherd.

Q#6 What offer did the king give to the shepherd & why did he refuse the offer? (Important)

Ans. The King offered to the shepherd that I want to make you the Abbot in place of the former Abbot but shepherd refused the offer because he didn't have any knowledge about reading or writing.

Q#7 Who was the king of England at the time of story and when did he resign?

Ans: King John was the ruler of England at the time story. He ruled the country from 1199 to 1216 A .D. He was not a good ruler because he ruled with power and unfair manners.

Q#8 What was an abbot?

Ans: Abbot means bishop. An abbot is the highest official of a local church. As here in this poem Abbot of Canterbury means the bishop of Canterbury, a county of England.

Q#9 Why was the King John hostile to the Abbot of Canterbury? (Important)

Ans: When the king heard about Abbot of Canterbury that he was leading a life far superior than him. He felt hostility against him and called him. In his court, and put the accusation of treason against him.

Q#10 What had the Abbot to do in order to save himself from being beheaded? (Important)

Ans: The abbot was asked three questions by the king. He was given a space of three weeks to answer the questions, and warned that if he failed to give the answers he would be beheaded.

Q#11 Why, on leaving the court, did he ride to Oxford and Cambridge?

Ans: The questions were obviously very difficult to answer, so the abbot went to the Oxford & Cambridge universities & to the other intellectuals to find the solutions.

Q#12 What was the shepherd doing when he met him?

Ans: The shepherd was going to the cattle-house when the abbot went back to his home and met him.

Q#13 How did the real abbot benefit from his shepherd's bold tricks? (Important)

Ans: The abbot succeeded in saving his life and got pardon from the king with the timely help of his shepherd.

Q#14 When he met the shepherd how many days had passed since the King had given him the three riddles to answer?

Ans: When the abbot met the shepherd, he (the abbot) had wasted most of the given time and only three days were left to give the answers of the questions.

Q#15 What did the shepherd propose to do?

Ans: The shepherd suggested the abbot that he (the shepherd) would go to answer the dispute because he not only knew the answers of the queries but he also resembles the abbot so no one in the whole London town would be able to identify him.

Q#16 In answering the riddle, how did the shepherd justify valuing the king at twenty-nine pence?

Ans: The shepherd told the king that it is said that Jesus Christ was sold among the Jews for thirty (30) pence.

The value of the king should not be more or equal to the Christ. So he is evaluated as only one penny less, than his worth will be 29 pence.

Q#17 How did he know the answer to the third riddle?

Ans: The shepherd knew that the king must be under the impression that the Abbot was answering the question. He used his disguise to the answer of the third question.

Q#18 How did King John behave on finding out that he had been deceived?

Ans: Unexpectedly, when the king came to know that he was being deceived, he was greatly amused & showed his joy after every answer to his question

Q#19 What reward did the shepherd receive?

Ans: The shepherd received a reward of a life time pension of four nobles a week.

Q#20 Who was an abbot and why was he victimized?

Ans: An abbot is a clergyman who is in charge of monastery. The king of England named king John heard about him that he was leading a far better life than he. That's why King John felt Jealous and asked three questions to him.

Q#21 Why was Abbot charged by the King John?

Ans: King Officials supplied the information about Abbot to the king. They told that he had great reputation and wealth and was living with great pomp and show. He kept better house and entertained the hundred men in his house. Thinking about all these things into the mind he (Abbot) was charged by the king John.

Q#22 How did Abbot prove himself innocent before king?

Ans: The Abbot proved himself innocent by requesting before King John that he had never spent anything which was not his own but spent my own money which I earn by the fair means. He further said that you will not punish me for the same act.

Q#23 Where did he go after receiving his punishment?

Ans: When he heard the punishment, he became very sad and went to the oxford and Cambridge University and met the learned and the wise men. All the people failed to answer them and excused to the abbot.

Q#24 How did he come to know about abbot and how did king treat him?

Ans: King officials supplied the information about abbot to the king John that Abbot is leading a for better life than you. After hearing it, king felt envy and put three hard questions to him. He alarmed him of he is not able to ask thin questions so he has to lose his live and life.

Q#25 What are crozier, miter rochet and cope?

Ans: These are all parts of the ceremonial attire of a bishop or abbot. The crosier is a staff of office like a shepherd's cloak but often richly ornamented. The miter is a tall cap. The rochet is gown and the cap is a cloak worn over the rocket.

Q#26 What is the main idea of this ballad? (Important)

Ans: The main idea of this ballad is 'Don't judge the book by its cover.' Sometimes a foolish person may talk intelligently. We should never underestimate anyone.



Poem#07

"Sur Khahori"

Introduction

Khahori means wandering ascetics or those who search. This sur contains the verses on the wandering life of ascetics who symbolize search of reality by following spiritual path to have glimpses of the reality.

Introduction to the Poet

Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai (1689-1752) was born at a village near Halla Haveli of present district Matiari, Sindh. His father Syed Habib was one of the prominent figures in the area. Shah Abdul Latif was a pious person and had nothing to do with worldly luxuries. He spent his whole life in worship and austerities. His poetry's collection 'Shah Jo Risalo' is the poetry of love, kindness, brotherhood, peace and love of motherland. Shah Jo Risalo consists of 30 chapters and each chapter is called "Sur". The poetry of Shah Latif portrays nature and its signs in a generally clear and enthusiastic way. The impact of his great work on Sindhi literature is so incredible which intoxicated all the writers after his time.

Introduction to the Translator

Amina Khamisani (1919-2007) was a renowned educationist and writer. She did her M.A English from University of Sindh and Diploma in English Literature from Oxford University, UK. She served as a faculty member of English Department, University of Sindh. Her remarkable work is the translation of Shah Jo Risalo in English.

Explanation of Verses

*Mother! I saw those, who have Beloved seen,
One must stay a night with those who with God have been,
Their recognition becomes a raft in this ocean of the world.*

He pays tribute to the ascetics people and praising them. Those people are rare and they are extremely noble among the people because they live for their god, their aims are noble. Shah says one must live or stay a night with them and then you able to find their noble mindedness.

*Khahoris prepared early to depart,
Searching in the rocks, reduced to bones they are,
Giving much trouble to their bodies, they sought their goal.*

These pious people depart early in the morning, their journey is pious they go to such places where no one else can go, nor anyone has knowledge about them. They search in mountains not even caring about themselves, they are the seekers who seek and find their goals even after so much trouble they never stop.

Their faces are dry, on their feet are slippers old and torn,
They traversed that land, where even the knowing ones are lost,
Their secretive ones, talk secrets of that far off land

These pious people even so much exhausted but didn't stop, they wear old and torn shoes but it doesn't matter to them, they travelled on the land and achieved their goals where the greatest leader cannot reach. These people know the secret of this world and have deeper knowledge and mesmerized identity and are beyond from the ordinary people

*Where not a trace of birds is seen, fire is lit,
Who save a group of ascetics, can kindle it?*

These people go to that places where not even a bird can be seen, but without any fear they love to find out the secrets of this world. No one can easily understand them but one who live with them will totally changed and awaken to a new world.

*Those who went to jungle were not misled,
Those on high way were way-laid,
Those who gave up both the worlds, were from ignorance saved.*

They wander in the jungles and possess nothing except their steadfastness and determination. The sky provides them shelter and the earth is their resting-place. Facing the storms of suffering and pain, they are completely absorbed in their dedication to achieve their objective. These people were never deceive from their path they left the world and saved themselves.

*True seekers still exist,
Known only to those who are for spiritual realms,
Having found them, they have built their nests close to them.*

Still people like them are exist in this world who want to leave every thing behind, and want to find out the hidden secret. People like these found each other and try to be close and learn from them.

Words-Meanings

No	Words	Contextual Meaning
		I
1	traversed	<u>travel</u> across or through.
2	ascetics	a person who follows a solitary life.
3	ridge	a long, narrow hilltop, mountain

4	desolation	emptiness or destruction
5	grieving	intense sorrow.
6	highland	an area of high or mountainous land
7	rambling	lengthy and confused
8	flicker	twinkle/ brightness

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Khahois trouble their bodies to attain their
a. **Goal** b. class c. earnings d. Destination
2. Khahoris face severe while achieving their goals.
a. criticism b. conditions c. **hardships** d. all of them
3. Khahoris never take their when they have goals.
a. Property b. **care** c. followers d. None
4. "Khahoris' faces are dry, on their feet are slippers old and to shows the
a. **Struggle** b. emotion c. hardships d. Pleasure
5. Khahoris recognition is like
a. caravan in desert b. **raft in ocean**
c. guide in mountains d. safety in ingle
6. Khahoris can be found even where there is no trace of:
a. human beings b. animals c. **birds** d. Cattle
7. In fourth stanza, the word 'save' is used in sense of
a. Safety b. preservation c. together d. Except
8. True seekers can only be known to those who are for
a. jungle dwelling b. deserted abodes
c. mountain peaks d. **spiritual realm**

Questions and Answers

1. How is Khahori's character depicted by the poet?

Ans. The poet has mentioned the character of Khahori as pious and the one who is only in the search of truth. Khahori travels place to place and suffer through many hardships in order to reach at his destination. They are not misled infact they lit the fire where not any trace of birds is seen. Writer called them true seekers and they are only known to those who has spritual realms.

2. How do the Khahoris experience sleep?

Ans. In his sleep Khahoris saw those people who had seen their beloved (truth). He further experienced that we should have to spend night with such people who lived with God. The recognition of such people is like a boat in the ocean.

They never experience restful sleep. They wander and totally absorbed in search and possess nothing except their steadfastness and determination.

3. Where and why do Khahoris spend their days and nights?

Ans. Khahoris usually spend their days and nights in the rocks, jungles and other unknown places where native people are hesitant to go. The purpose of spending their time at such places is to search for truth, to make their God pleased with them.

5. What reward does a Khahori get after his hard work?

Ans. After his struggle Khahori is rewarded with the eternal truth for whom he was seeking. They saw their beloved and spend nights with God.

6. Sur Khahori is the narration of Khahoris' struggle. Elaborate.

Ans. This is sur of Khahori is based on the struggle of Khahori because Shah latif has mentioned many examples of their struggles. For example "searching in rocks, reduced to bones they are", "Giving so much trouble to their bodies". "their faces are dry, on their feet are slippers old and torn"

7. Which poetic devices have been used in this poetry? Write with the examples.

Ans.

- Metaphor

Example: a raft in the ocean in the world

- Hyperbole

Example: reduced to bones they are,

- Euphism (indirect word or expression)

Example: Those who went to jungle were not misled,